

THEME 2 · B1+/B2

Classics

2A Beyond the Times — talking about past events, movies/books/music, expressing preferences

2B The Silver Screen — analysing character traits, short stories and movies

Warm-up

Look at the title: Classics. What do you think we will talk about in this theme? Tell your partner two ideas.

VOCABULARY

New words

20 target words

classic

n./adj.



klasik

Many critics consider the film a classic, even though it was made over fifty years ago.

timeless

adj.



zamansız

The novel's themes of love and loss feel timeless, even today.

plot

n.



olay örgüsü

The plot follows a young sailor who returns home after twenty years at sea.

setting

n.



mekân/ortam (öykünün geçtiği yer ve zaman)

The setting of the novel is a small fishing village in the 1920s.

protagonist

n.



başkahraman

The protagonist has to choose between loyalty to her family and her own dreams.

antagonist

n.



karşıt karakter, hasım

The antagonist is not a villain in the traditional sense, but a rival who wants the same job.

narrator

n.



anlatıcı

The narrator only reveals part of the truth, so readers have to guess the rest.

adaptation

n.



uyarlama

The film adaptation left out several characters from the original novel.

screenplay

n.



senaryo

She spent three years writing the screenplay before filming began.

soundtrack

n.



film müziği

The soundtrack became almost as famous as the film itself.

cast

n.



oyuncu kadrosu

The cast rehearsed for months before the first scene was filmed.

director

n.



yönetmen

The director insisted on filming every scene in natural light.

novelist

n.



romancı

The novelist based the main character on someone she met as a child.

masterpiece

n.



başyapıt

Critics still call the painting a masterpiece of its period.

bestseller

n.



çok satan kitap

The novel became an unexpected bestseller within weeks of publication.

sequel

n.



devam filmi/kitabı

Fans waited five years for the sequel to come out.

remake

n.



yeniden çevrim

The remake used modern special effects, but kept the original's slow, quiet pace.

moving

adj.



duygulandırıcı

The final scene is so moving that many viewers leave the cinema in tears.

gripping

adj.



sürükleyici

The last hundred pages are so gripping that I couldn't put the book down.

thought-provoking

adj.



düşündürücü

It's a thought-provoking story about memory and identity.

Quick game · What's the word?

“uyarlama”

a setting

b plot

c adaptation

Quick game · What's the word?

“anlatıcı”

a narrator

b classic

c setting

Quick game · What's the word?

“duygulandırıcı”

a classic

b moving

c plot

Quick game · What's the word?

“senaryo”

a classic

b screenplay

c gripping

Quick game · What's the word?

“düşündürücü”

a adaptation

b antagonist

c thought-provoking

Quick game · What's the word?

“devam filmi/kitabı”

a plot

b setting

c sequel

GRAMMAR

Simple Past, Past Continuous & used to: Narrating Past Events and Life Stories

Notice

The young director **grew up** in a small coastal town before she moved to the city to study film.

While the actors **were rehearsing** the final scene, a sudden storm hit the old studio.

As a child, she **used to watch** black-and-white classics with her grandmother every Sunday.

By the time the credits **rolled**, most of the audience **was wiping** away tears.

Which sentences describe a single completed action, which describe an action in progress that was interrupted, and which describe a repeated habit from the past that isn't true anymore?

The rule

Use the Simple Past for completed past actions (grew up, wrote, watched). Use the Past Continuous (was/were + -ing) for actions in progress in the past, often interrupted by another action. Use used to + base verb for repeated past habits or states that are no longer true.

TR Tamamlanmış geçmiş zaman eylemleri için Simple Past kullanılır (grew up, wrote, watched). Geçmişte devam eden ve genellikle başka bir eylem tarafından kesilen eylemler için Past Continuous kullanılır (was/were + -ing). Artık doğru olmayan, tekrarlanan geçmiş alışkanlıklar veya durumlar için used to + fiil kullanılır.

When? We use these forms to narrate the plot of a book or film, to tell the life story of an author or director, or to talk about our own past habits and experiences with stories.

TR Bir kitabın ya da filmin olay örgüsünü, bir yazarın veya yönetmenin hayatını anlatırken ya da geçmişteki alışkanlıklarımızdan bahsederken bu yapıları kullanırız.

Build sentences · Example

the author

+

grow up / in a village

+

before he became famous

The author grew up in a village before he became famous.

Build sentences

she

+

write / her first novel

+

at the age of nineteen

She wrote her first novel at the age of nineteen.

Build sentences

while the crew + film / the final scene + it started raining heavily

While the crew was filming the final scene, it started raining heavily.

Build sentences

as a teenager, he

+

use to / read / one book a week

As a teenager, he used to read one book a week.

Build sentences

the composer

+

not use to / like / his own soundtrack

+

at first

The composer didn't use to like his own soundtrack at first.

Build sentences

? / you

+

ever / watch

+

a film that changed the way you thought

Did you ever watch a film that changed the way you thought?

Your turn

Write four sentences about a book or film you remember from your childhood: what you used to do, one completed event, and one thing that was happening when something else interrupted it.

When I was younger, I used to...

One day, while I was reading/watching...

I finally finished the book/film when...

I remember that I...

Form

POSITIVE

She wrote three novels
before she turned thirty.
He used to read comic
books every evening.

NEGATIVE

They didn't finish the film
because the ending was
too sad.
She didn't use to enjoy
classic literature.

QUESTION

Did the director grow up
near the sea?
What were you doing when
the twist was revealed?

SHORT ANSWERS

Yes, she did. / No, she
didn't.
I was watching the final
scene.

Error detective

While she was writing the novel, she has three young children.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **While she was writing the novel, she had three young children.**

Error detective

He use to watch old films every Sunday.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ He used to watch old films every Sunday.

Error detective

The audience was crying when the film ended suddenly.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ The audience was crying when the film ended. / The audience cried when the film suddenly ended.

A • Choose the correct option.

The novelist _____ her first bestseller when she was only twenty-two.

a wrote

b was writing

c use to write

A · Choose the correct option.

While the director _____ the final scene, the lead actor injured his leg.

a filmed

b was filming

c used to film

A · Choose the correct option.

As a child, I _____ read comic books every night, but now I prefer novels.

a used to

b was

c wrote

B · Complete with the correct form.

The composer _____ (grow up) in a musical family before he wrote his first film score.

✓ grew up

B · Complete with the correct form.

The audience _____ (still / watch) the credits when the lights suddenly came on.

✓ **was still watching**

B · Complete with the correct form.

She _____ (not use to) enjoy poetry until her teacher introduced her to it.

✓ **didn't use to**

C · Judge the sentence.

The novelist use to write every morning before breakfast.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **The novelist used to write every morning before breakfast.**

C · Judge the sentence.

While she was reading the final chapter, she started crying.

a Correct

b Incorrect

C · Judge the sentence.

The director was direct his first film in 1998.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **The director directed his first film in 1998.**

Dialogue · Complete with the correct past form.

A: What _____ you _____ (do) when you first heard the news about the sequel?

✓ were / doing

Dialogue · Complete with the correct past form.

B: I _____ (read) the first book, and I nearly _____ (drop) it from excitement!

✓ was reading / dropped

Dialogue · Reorder the sentence.

novels / used / she / romantic / read / to

read

novels

she

romantic

used

to

•

✓ **She used to read romantic novels.**

GRAMMAR

Expressing Preferences: prefer, would rather and comparatives

Notice

I **prefer** reading the book before watching the film adaptation.

"Honestly, I **'d rather** watch a classic than a new blockbuster," she admitted.

For me, the novel is **far more moving** than the film ever could be.

Of all the director's works, most critics agree this one is **the most thought-provoking**.

Which structures compare two specific things directly, and which one picks out the best or most extreme example from a whole group?

The rule

'Prefer + noun/-ing' expresses a general preference (I prefer novels to films). 'Would rather + base verb' expresses a preference for a specific moment or situation (I'd rather read than watch TV). Use a comparative (more ... than) to compare two specific things directly, and a superlative (the most ...) to pick out the most extreme example in a whole group.

TR 'Prefer + isim/-ing' genel bir tercihi ifade eder (I prefer novels to films). 'Would rather + fiilin yalın hali' belirli bir anda ya da durumda yapılacak tercihi belirtir (I'd rather read than watch TV). İki şeyi doğrudan karşılaştırmak için karşılaştırma sıfatı (more ... than), bir grubun en uç örneğini belirtmek için ise üstünlük sıfatı (the most ...) kullanılır.

When? We use these structures when comparing a book with its film adaptation, choosing between two classic works, or describing a work as the best or most striking example within a group.

TR Bir kitap ile filmini karşılaştırırken, iki klasik eser arasında tercih yaparken ya da bir eseri bir grup içinde en iyi/en etkileyici olarak nitelendirirken bu yapıları kullanınız.

Build sentences · Example

I + prefer / classic novels + modern thrillers

I prefer classic novels to modern thrillers.

Build sentences

she

+

would rather / read the book

+

watch the adaptation

She would rather read the book than watch the adaptation.

Build sentences

this novel

+

be / far more gripping

+

the sequel

This novel is far more gripping than the sequel.

Build sentences

for many critics

+

this / be / the most moving

+

film of the decade

For many critics, this is the most moving film of the decade.

Build sentences

I + not / prefer / remakes + original films

I don't prefer remakes to original films.

Build sentences

? / you

+

would rather / read a poem or watch a film

+

about the same story

Would you rather read a poem or watch a film about the same story?

Your turn

Write four sentences comparing a book and its film adaptation, or two classic stories you know, using prefer, would rather and at least one comparative or superlative.

I prefer...

I'd rather...

In my opinion, ... is more ... than ...

Of all the classics I know, ... is the most ...

Form

POSITIVE

I prefer reading to watching TV.

She'd rather finish the novel first.

NEGATIVE

He doesn't prefer remakes to originals.

I wouldn't rather watch the sequel; I'd rather reread the book.

QUESTION

Do you prefer books or films?

Would you rather watch the classic or the remake?

SHORT ANSWERS

I prefer books. / I prefer films.

I'd rather watch the classic.

Error detective

I prefer books than films.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **I prefer books to films.**

Error detective

I'd rather to read than watch.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **I'd rather read than watch.**

Error detective

This novel is more interesting than the film ever could.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **This novel is more interesting than the film could ever be.**

A • Choose the correct option.

I _____ classic novels _____ modern thrillers.

a prefer / to

b prefer / than

c would rather / to

A • Choose the correct option.

Honestly, I _____ read the poem again before we discuss it.

a prefer

b 'd rather

c the most

A • Choose the correct option.

For many readers, this is _____ ending in the whole series.

a more moving

b the most moving

c moving than

B · Complete with the correct form.

She _____ (prefer) the original story _____ any of the remakes.

✓ **prefers / to**

B · Complete with the correct form.

I'd _____ (rather) reread an old favourite than start something new.

✓ rather

B · Complete with the correct form.

This character is far _____ (interesting) than the protagonist.

✓ more interesting

C · Judge the sentence.

I prefer novels than short stories.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **I prefer novels to short stories.**

C · Judge the sentence.

I'd rather watch the film first.

a Correct

b Incorrect

C · Judge the sentence.

This is the more gripping book I have ever read.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **This is the most gripping book I have ever read.**

Dialogue · Complete with the correct preference form.

A: Would you _____ read the book or watch the film first?

✓ rather

Dialogue · Complete with the correct preference form.

**B: I _____ (prefer) the book, because it's usually _____
(detailed) than the film.**

✓ prefer / more detailed

Dialogue · Reorder the sentence.

ending / most / moving / it / the / is / film's / the

it

the

is

film's

moving

most

ending

•

✓ It is the film's most moving ending.

READING

A Life Behind the Camera

Before you read

1. Look at the title. What kind of person do you think this text is about?
2. Do you know any directors or authors who became famous later in life? What was their early life like?

A LIFE BEHIND THE CAMERA · 1 / 3

Long before he became known for his dreamlike animated worlds, the director grew up in a quiet town far from any film studio. As a boy, he used to spend hours drawing his own comic strips instead of doing his homework, and his teachers often complained that he never paid attention in class. Nobody in his family had worked in film before, so when he announced that he wanted to make movies, his parents were quietly worried.

A LIFE BEHIND THE CAMERA · 2 / 3

His first years in the industry were far from glamorous. While he was working as a junior animator, he spent long nights redrawing scenes that senior directors rejected, and he nearly gave up more than once. Everything changed when he was finally allowed to direct a short film of his own. It told a simple story about a lonely girl and a magical forest, but audiences who saw it were deeply moved, and critics praised its gentle, thoughtful pace.

A LIFE BEHIND THE CAMERA · 3 / 3

Decades later, his films are studied in universities and loved by children and adults alike. He still insists that every frame should be drawn by hand whenever possible, even in an age of computer animation. When a journalist once asked why he never used more modern techniques, he simply replied that a story feels more honest when you can see the artist's hand behind it.

While you read

What did the director use to do as a boy, according to the text?

a

He worked in a film studio.

b

He drew his own comic strips instead of doing homework.

c

He wrote novels with his grandmother.

While you read

As a junior animator, he spent long nights _____ scenes that senior directors rejected.

✓ redrawing

While you read

What was his first short film about?

- a** A lonely girl and a magical forest
- b** A director's difficult childhood
- c** A famous novelist's life

While you read

According to the text, the director's family were experienced filmmakers who supported him immediately.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ According to the text, nobody in his family had worked in film before, and his parents were quietly worried.

While you read

He believes a story feels more honest when you can see the
_____ behind it.

✓ **artist's hand**

After you read

1. Why do you think the director still prefers hand-drawn animation, even today?
2. Would you rather watch a hand-drawn film or a computer-animated one? Why?

READING

What Makes a Story a Classic?

Before you read

1. Before you read, think of a book or film you consider a 'classic'. Why do you think it has lasted so long?
2. What do you think makes a fictional character memorable?

WHAT MAKES A STORY A CLASSIC? · 1 / 3

Every year, thousands of new novels and films are released, yet only a small number are still discussed decades later. So what separates a passing bestseller from a genuine classic? One answer lies in the characters themselves. A classic protagonist usually has flaws as well as strengths, which makes them feel believable rather than perfect. Readers remember characters who make difficult choices, not ones who always know exactly what to do.

WHAT MAKES A STORY A CLASSIC? · 2 / 3

Setting plays an important role too. Many classic stories are set in a specific time and place, yet they explore ideas that go far beyond that setting — loyalty, ambition, loss, forgiveness. A short story about a fisherman on a remote island can still say something true about any reader's own life, wherever and whenever they happen to be reading it.

WHAT MAKES A STORY A CLASSIC? · 3 / 3

Finally, a classic often rewards a second reading or a second viewing. On the first read, we usually focus on the plot: what happens next? On the second, we start to notice smaller details — a narrator who isn't entirely honest, an antagonist who has understandable reasons for their actions, a piece of dialogue that means something different once we know how the story ends. It's this depth, more than fame or sales figures, that keeps a story alive.

While you read

According to the text, what usually makes a classic protagonist feel believable?

a

Being perfect and never making mistakes

b

Having both flaws and strengths

c

Always knowing exactly what to do

While you read

The text says setting matters, but classic stories explore ideas that go far beyond that _____.

✓ **setting**

While you read

According to the text, a classic story usually only rewards one reading or viewing.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ According to the text, a classic often rewards a second reading or viewing, revealing new details.

While you read

What might a reader notice on a second reading, according to the text?

a

A completely different plot

b

Small details, such as an unreliable narrator

c

The exact sales figures of the book

While you read

The text concludes that it is depth, more than fame or _____, that keeps a story alive.

✓ sales figures

After you read

1. Do you agree that a story needs 'depth' to become a classic? Can you think of a counter-example?
2. Think of a story you've read or watched more than once. Did you notice something new the second time?

LISTENING

The Film We Used to Watch

Before you listen

1. Predict: what kind of film do you think two old friends might remember fondly from their childhood?

The Film We Used to Watch

Ses kaydı yakında — transkripti öğretmen okuyabilir.

While you listen

What did Kerem and Aslı use to do every winter?

a Write stories together

b Watch an old black-and-white film

c Visit a cinema in another city

While you listen

Kerem used to cry every time at the _____ .

✓ ending

While you listen

Kerem's little sister thought the film was faster than she expected.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **Kerem's little sister thought the film was slower than she expected.**

While you listen

What does Aslı prefer, according to the dialogue?

a

The remake, because it's more modern

b

The original film, because it's more moving

c

Neither the original nor the remake

LISTENING

Analysing a Character

Before you listen

1. What do you predict Mira will talk about — the plot, a character, or the setting?

Analysing a Character

Ses kaydı yakında — transkripti öğretmen okuyabilir.

While you listen

How does the protagonist seem at the beginning of the story, according to Mira?

a

Confident and
outspoken

b

Shy and unsure of
herself

c

Cruel and selfish

While you listen

When her village is threatened, she is the one who comes up with a _____ .

✓ **plan**

While you listen

According to Mira, the author directly tells the reader that the character is brave.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ According to Mira, the author never says it directly — the reader has to notice it through her actions.

While you listen

What does Mira find most thought-provoking about the story?

a

The narrator lets readers judge the character for themselves.

b

The story has a surprising ending.

c

The setting changes several times.

SPEAKING

Book or Film?

In pairs, discuss whether you prefer reading a story as a book or watching it as a film. Talk about at least two examples, using prefer, would rather, and comparatives/superlatives where natural.

SPEAKING

Analysing a Character

Prepare a two-minute talk analysing the character traits of a protagonist or antagonist from a classic book, short story or film you know well. Explain how the character changes, and support your ideas with details from the story.

WRITING

Describing a Film or Novel Poster

Choose a classic film or novel and write a short descriptive paragraph about its poster or cover. Describe what you can see, the mood it creates, and why you think it suits the story.

WRITING

A Short Narrative: A Story I'll Never Forget

Write a short narrative paragraph about a book or film that made a strong impression on you. Use Simple Past, Past Continuous and used to where appropriate, and finish by explaining why the story still matters to you.

REVIEW

Exit ticket

Exit ticket

As a child, she _____ read comic books every evening.

a used to

b was

c wrote

Exit ticket

While the director _____ the final scene, it started to rain.

a filmed

b was filming

c use to film

Exit ticket

The novelist _____ (grow up) in a small village before she moved to the city.

✓ grew up

Exit ticket

I _____ (prefer) reading _____ watching TV.

✓ prefer / to

Exit ticket

Which sentence correctly uses 'would rather'?

a

I'd rather to watch the film.

b

I'd rather watch the film.

c

I'd rather watching the film.

Exit ticket

This is the more gripping novel I have ever read.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **This is the most gripping novel I have ever read.**

Exit ticket

He didn't _____ (use to) enjoy poetry until his teacher introduced him to it.

✓ **use to**

Exit ticket

Which word describes a character who opposes the main character?

a protagonist

b antagonist

c narrator

Exit ticket

A film or TV version of a book is called an _____.

✓ **adaptation**

Exit ticket

A work of art considered one of the best of its kind is called a

_____ .

a masterpiece

b sequel

c remake

Exit ticket

Put the words in order.

romantic

she

read

to

novels

used

•

✓ **She used to read romantic novels.**

Exit ticket

I prefer novels than short stories.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **I prefer novels to short stories.**

Exit ticket

Rewrite using the correct past form.

(She writes her first novel at the age of nineteen. (rewrite in the past))

✓ **She wrote her first novel at the age of nineteen.**

Exit ticket

The audience _____ (still / watch) the credits when the lights came on.

✓ was still watching